

A First Forgiveness Inventory

By Rabbi Yisroel Bernath

Observation #1: Who's Living in Your Head?

Think of someone who's hurt you. Someone whose name, memory, or even voice still stirs tension inside when they come to mind.

Now ask yourself:

- *How often do they intrude into your thoughts?*
- *Are they taking up more space than they deserve?*
- *What would it feel like to evict them — not from your story, but from your inner peace?*

Write their name here:

Now write: *"I am choosing not to let you own my peace anymore."*

Observation #2: What's the Coal You're Still Holding?

You're carrying a hot coal, ready to throw it at someone.

But your hand is burning.

- *What is the grudge you're still gripping tightly?*
- *What does holding it give you? (Control? Identity? Safety?)*
- *What is it costing you?*

Write it out in one sentence:

"The coal I've been holding is..." _____
"

Now write:

"Today, I begin loosening my grip."

The Letting Go Formula

Take a few moments. Find a quiet space, a pen, and an open heart.

You're not trying to fix anything yet — just observe with honesty and curiosity.

This is your soul's laboratory.

1. Check Your Emotional Backpack

Which burdens are you still carrying?

Write down 2–3 resentments (recent or long-standing).

Think of each one as a heavy rock you've been carrying around in your emotional backpack.

Rock #1:

Rock #2:

(Optional) Rock #3:

NOW REFLECT: *How has carrying this emotional weight affected you?*

Physically:

Mentally:

Relationally:

Other:

Example: "When I think of her, I clench my jaw all day."

"I avoid people who remind me of that time, and I feel isolated."

2. Imagine Forgiveness

Now gently close your eyes.

Picture yourself taking one of those rocks out of your backpack... and setting it down. Just for a moment.

What does that feel like?

Words or images that come up:

Example: "Lighter. Like I can finally breathe."

"Hope." "Space for joy."

3. Your Motivation Reminder

Complete this sentence in your own words:

I choose to forgive because...

EXAMPLES:

"I want to live free."

"Because peace feels better than pain."

"Because I'm worth it."

Write this on a sticky note, a card for your mirror, or make it your phone wallpaper.

Let it follow you gently this week.